

Certified Algorithms for the Weighted Feedback Vertex Set and Travelling Salesman Problems

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1 Introduction

This section introduces the topic and provides background information.

2 Preliminaries

In this section, we provide the reader with the necessary information in order to follow the paper. We start off with a reminder on Graph Theory. After that, we move to more advanced definitions in the field of Combinatorial Optimization. Finally, we get on topic by introducing perturbation resilience and certified algorithms from the field of Beyond the Worst-Case Analysis of Algorithms.

2.1 Graph Theory

In this section, the authors refer to Bondy and Murty [1]. A *graph* G is an ordered pair denoted as $(V(G), E(G))$. The set $V(G)$ is called a set of *vertices* and the set $E(G)$, a set of *edges*. The incidence function ψ_G associates each edge with an unordered pair of (not necessarily unique) vertices. The ordered pair and the incidence function define the graph G . We are going to use n as the cardinality of the set V and m for the set of edges E . With each edge e of G , let there be associated a real number $w(e)$, called its *weight*. Then G , together with the weighting function $w : E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, is called a *weighted graph*, and denoted (G, w) .

A graph is can be *embedded in the plane*, or is *planar* if it can be drawn on the plane in a way that edges intersect each other only at their ends. Such a drawing is called a *planar embedding* of the graph. A graph G is called *outerplanar* if it has a planar embedding $\tilde{G}$ in which all the vertices lie on the boundary of the outer face. This is also called a *1-outerplanar graph*. Two forbidden minors of that class are the K_4 and $K_{2,3}$ graphs. In the next subsection we familiarize the reader with Baker's approach [2]. Here we define a *k-outerplanar* to be a graph that has a planar embedding in which the vertices belong to at most k concentric layers. Every planar graph is *k-outerplanar* for some k . Given a graph G , we look for *k-outerplanar* embedding of G for which k is minimal.

2.2 Combinatorial Optimization

In this section, we refer to the book on Combinatorial Optimization by Korte and Vygen [3] and Williamson and Shmoys [4]. We are going to be looking at two problems, namely the Feedback Vertex Set and Travelling Salesman

Problem. Both of those problems belong to the class of **NP-complete** problems. The former was also part of Karp's 21 problems [5]. The weighted version of the problem can be defined as:

Definition 2.1: Minimum Weight Feedback Vertex Set

Instance:

- An undirected weighted graph (G, w) , where $G = (V, E)$ and $w : V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$.

Task: Find a vertex set $X \subseteq V$ such that:

- $G \setminus X$ is acyclic (i.e., a forest)
- The sum of the weights of the vertices in X is minimized.

The other problem we inspect is an edge-optimization problem, namely the Travelling Salesman Problem (TSP).

Definition 2.2: Travelling Salesman Problem

Instance:

- A set of cities $C = \{c_1, c_2, \dots, c_n\}$.
- A distance function $w : C \times C \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ that gives the distance between each pair of cities.

Task: Find a permutation π of the cities such that:

- The total distance travelled is minimized, i.e., minimize

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} w(c_{\pi(i)}, c_{\pi(i+1)}) + w(c_{\pi(n)}, c_{\pi(1)}).$$

As we mentioned, both of the problems are **NP-complete**, so we turn to *approximation algorithms* in order to cope with the hardness of the problems. Let Π be an optimization problem with nonnegative weights and $k \geq 1$. A *k-factor approximation algorithm* for Π is a polynomial-time algorithm A for Π , such that

$$A(I) \leq k \times OPT(I)$$

for all instances I of Π . We say A has performance ratio k . The inequality shown is true for minimization problems. This definition is for algorithms for constant-factor approximation or algorithms for **NP** optimization problems that belong to the class **APX** (an abbreviation for "approximable"). A

polynomial-time approximation scheme (PTAS) is a family of algorithms A_ϵ where there is an algorithm for each $\epsilon > 0$, such that A_ϵ is a $(1 + \epsilon)$ -approximation algorithm (for minimization problems). The running time of the algorithm A_ϵ is polynomial, but can depend arbitrarily on $1/\epsilon$. This dependence could be exponential or even worse.

Definition 2.3: Polynomial-Time Approximation Scheme (PTAS)

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2.2.1 Baker's approach

2.2.2 Linear Programming and Randomized Rounding

One way of approximating solutions is done through Linear Programming (LP). For a more detailed review on Linear Programming the reader can consult Chapter 3 of Korte and Vygen [3]. The algorithm we use solves a linear relaxation which provides fractional values as solutions. We then round this fractional solution to an integral one, but rather than doing it deterministically, we do the process randomly. This technique is called *randomized rounding*.

2.3 Beyond the Worst-Case Analysis of Algorithms

In this section we explore perturbation-resilience, also known as γ -*stability* or Bilu-Linial stability. The authors refer to the original paper of the two authors Bilu and Linial [6] as well as a survey on the matter by Makarychev and Makarychev [7]. In a later work Makarychev and Makarychev define γ -*certified algorithms* [8].

The following definitions for γ -perturbation are for edge-optimization and vertex-optimization problems respectively. Afterwards, we are going to define stability and certified algorithms for vertex-optimization problems only.

Definition 2.4: γ -perturbation for Edge-Optimization problems

Consider a weighted graph $G = (V, E, w)$ with a set of edge weights w_e . An instance $G' = (V, E, w')$ is a γ -perturbation ($\gamma \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 1}$) of G if $w(e) \leq w'(e) \leq \gamma \times w(e)$; that is, if we can obtain a perturbed instance from the original by multiplying the weight of each edge by a number between 1 and γ (the number may vary for each edge).

From now on, the definitions will concentrate on Vertex-Optimization problems.

Definition 2.5: γ -perturbation for Vertex-Optimization problems

Consider a weighted graph (G, w) . For any $\gamma \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 1}$ a γ -perturbation of the weight function $w : V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is a function $w' : V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ satisfying $w(v) \leq w'(v) \leq \gamma \times w(v) \forall v \in V$.

Definition 2.6: γ -stability

For any $\gamma \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 1}$, a γ -stable instance (G, w) of a *vertex-minimization* problem Π is an instance admitting a unique optimal solution S which remains optimal even under γ -perturbations of (G, w) .

Definition 2.7: Certified Algorithm

A γ -certified solution to an instance (G, w) of a weighted vertex-optimization problem Π is a pair (S, w') where w' is a γ -perturbation of w and S is an optimal solution on (G, w') .

3 Methods

This section introduces the topic and provides background information.

4 Results

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5 Conclusion

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